

Insurance Commission Reconciliation â Buy vs Build Scorecard

#Decision Goal

Select the best path to launch a reliable commission reconciliation capability for Tomlinson & Co (100+ carriers) with measurable ROI in 90 days.

#Options Compared

- Option A: Buy (single vendor platform)
- Option B: Build in-house (Manus/OpenClaw/Lindy + internal workflow stack)
- Option C: Hybrid (buy for ingestion + build internal exception workflow/reporting)

#Weighted Criteria (100 points total)

Criterion	Weight	Why it matters
Carrier format coverage	15	100+ carriers means ingestion breadth is critical
Match accuracy + rules flexibility	15	Policy-level trust determines adoption
Exception workflow quality	12	Recovery depends on fast, assignable exception handling
Split/override complexity support	10	Producer compensation integrity
Integrations (CD/QuoteRUSH/Drive/Email)	10	Must fit existing operating stack
Time-to-value	10	Need operational gains quickly
Total cost of ownership (12 months)	10	Budget discipline vs hidden effort
Reporting + auditability	8	Management visibility + controls
Security/compliance posture	5	Data and access governance
Portability/vendor lock risk	5	Exit options and data ownership

#Scoring Scale

- 1 = poor
- 3 = acceptable
- 5 = strong

Weighted Score = (Score / 5) * Weight

#Initial Scorecard (Draft)

Criterion	Weight	Buy	Build	Hybrid
Carrier format coverage	15	4	2	4
Match accuracy + rules flexibility	15	3	4	4
Exception workflow quality	12	3	4	5

Split/override support	10	4	3	4
Integrations fit	10	3	5	4
Time-to-value	10	4	2	4
12-mo TCO	10	2	4	3
Reporting + auditability	8	4	4	5
Security/compliance	5	4	3	4
Portability/lock risk	5	2	5	4
Total (out of 100)		66.4	70.4	84.0

#Interpretation

- Hybrid currently scores best: fastest practical path without giving up control.
- Build-only can win long-term but slower first value.
- Buy-only can launch quickly but may create lock-in and integration compromises.

#Recommendation (Current)

##Choose Hybrid for v1-v2

1. Use vendor capabilities for high-friction ingestion/parsing where they are strongest.
2. Keep exception queue, workflow routing, and management reporting in your internal stack.
3. Preserve normalized internal data model so you can swap vendors later.

#90-Day Plan by Option

#If Hybrid (recommended)

- Days 1â 14: Pilot top 10â 20 carriers with clear match/variance metrics
- Days 15â 45: Add exception routing + owner SLA + dispute templates
- Days 46â 90: Expand to majority carrier volume; publish weekly recovery dashboard

#If Build-only

- Days 1â 30: Ingestion + canonical schema + exact match
- Days 31â 60: Fuzzy match + exception Kanban + reporting
- Days 61â 90: Scale carrier coverage + optimize recovery workflow

#If Buy-only

- Days 1â 14: Vendor onboarding + data mapping
- Days 15â 45: Validate match rates + split logic + exception handling
- Days 46â 90: Lock governance + exit/data export safeguards

#Vendor Due Diligence Questions (Use in demos)

1. What policy-level match rate do clients achieve at 30/60/90 days?
2. How do you handle carrier statement format drift over time?

3. Can we customize tolerance and reason-code logic per carrier?
4. How are producer splits/overrides versioned and audited?
5. What are full export options (raw + normalized + audit logs)?
6. What implementation support is included vs paid add-on?
7. Can we keep our own exception workflow while using your ingestion layer?
8. Contract: term, auto-renewal, overages, termination, data return SLA?

#KPI Benchmarks to Track (avoid marketing fluff)

- Policy-level match rate
- Net variance recovered (\$)
- Exception aging (median days)
- Manual hours reduced
- Close-cycle time reduction
- Carrier dispute win rate

#Final Decision Gate

Proceed with selected path only if pilot meets:

- $\geq 85\%$ policy-level match on pilot carriers
- ≤ 5 business days median exception resolution
- Demonstrable monthly recovery value
- Acceptable 12-month TCO and operational fit